

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 15

Jumla Ismiyyah · The Mu'arraḥ bil Lam as Muḥtada

1. The Murakkab and the kinds of Jumlah

A collection of words in Arabic made up of two or more words is called a *Murakkab*. The *Murakkab* is basically of two kinds.

Kind	Definition
Murakkab Tamm	A Murakkab from which the full sense is understood — that is, it is a complete sentence
Murakkab Naqis	A Murakkab from which the full sense is not obtained — that is, it is not a sentence

In Arabic grammar a sentence is of two kinds: a *Jumla Ismiyyah* is one that begins with an *Ism*, and a *Jumla Fi'liyyah* is one that begins with a *Fi'l*.

2. The parts of a Jumla Ismiyyah

A *Jumla Ismiyyah* is made up of two fundamental parts.

- *Muḥtada* — the *Ism* with which a *Jumla Ismiyyah* begins.
- *Khabar* — the part of the sentence that supplies some information or report about the *Muḥtada*. The *Khabar* may be an *Ism* and it may also be a *Fi'l*.

The three conditions for the Muḥtada and the Khabar

Condition	Details	How strictly it holds
Wus'at	The <i>Ism</i> made the <i>Muḥtada</i> must be Ma'rifah, and the <i>Ism</i> made the <i>Khabar</i> must be Nakirah	99 percent
I'raab	Both the <i>Muḥtada</i> and the <i>Khabar</i> are Marfoo'. Whatever noun occupies the place of <i>Muḥtada</i> or <i>Khabar</i> always remains in the state of raf'	100 percent
'Adad and Jins	Both are Wahid, or both Tathniyah, or both Jam'. Likewise both are Mudhakkar or both Mu'annath	99 percent

The reason for the exceptions: Some nouns are used only as masculine or only as feminine and have no counterpart of the opposite gender. In such cases the condition of agreement in gender cannot be met, and it is here that the exceptional situations arise.

3. The Ism ul 'Alam as Mubtada

The examples below are formed by placing the *Ism ul 'Alam* — one of the categories of the *Ma'rifah*, being a person's particular name — in the position of *Mubtada*.

Examples in the singular masculine

Sentence	Translation	Mubtada and Khabar
مُحَمَّدٌ نَبِيٌّ	Muhammad (peace be upon him) is a Prophet	مُحَمَّدٌ Mubtada , نَبِيٌّ Khabar
مُحَمَّدٌ رَسُولٌ	Muhammad (peace be upon him) is a Messenger	مُحَمَّدٌ Mubtada , رَسُولٌ Khabar
مُحَمَّدٌ أَمِينٌ	Muhammad (peace be upon him) is trustworthy	مُحَمَّدٌ Mubtada , أَمِينٌ Khabar

Analysis of the first example: مُحَمَّدٌ is *Ma'rifah* for being an *Ism ul 'Alam*, is *Marfoo'*, and is singular masculine. And نَبِيٌّ is *Nakirah*, is *Marfoo'*, and is singular masculine. So all three conditions are met.

An important difference of wording

جِبْرِيلُ مَلَكٌ

(Jibril, peace be upon him, is an angel)

The word جِبْرِيلُ is a *Ghayr Munsarif* noun, so it has become the *Mubtada* without *Tanween*. And مَلَكٌ, with a fathah on the lam, has become the *Khabar* in the sense of angel.

The difference between Malak and Malik: مَلَكٌ with a fathah on the lam means **an angel**, whereas مَلِكٌ with a kasrah on the lam means **a king**. A single vowel changes the meaning entirely.

An example in the Tathniyah

يُؤَسِّفُ وَيُؤَسِّسُ نَبِيَّانِ

(Yusuf and Yunus, peace be upon them, are Prophets)

Apart from six, all the names of the Prophets are *Ghayr Munsarif*, that is, they take neither *Tanween* nor a kasrah. This is why يُوسُفُ and يُونُسُ carry only a single dammah. Since the *Mubtada* is two, the *Khabar* too has come in the *Tathniyah* of the state of *raf'*, namely نَبِيَّانِ, recognised by the aani sound.

Examples in the Jam'

بَابِلُ وَمَدْيَنُ وَمَكَّةُ بِلَادٌ

(Babil, Madyan and Makkah are cities)

In Arabic the names of cities and countries are *Ghayr Munsarif*, so no *Tanween* has come upon them. Since the *Mubtada* is three, that is, a *Jam'*, the *Khabar* too has been brought as a *Jam'*, namely بِلَادٌ. The plural of بَلَدٌ is بِلَادٌ, and this word is used for both a city and a country.

وَهَذَا الْبَلَدِ الْأَمِينِ

(Surah at-Tin: 3) Translation: and by this city of security

الْأَوْلَادُ صَالِحُونَ

(the boys are righteous)

الْأَوْلَادُ is a *Jam' Mukassar*, and the state of *raf'* of a *Jam' Mukassar* comes with a dammah. Whereas صَالِحُونَ is a *Jam' Salim Mudhakkar*, whose state of *raf'* comes with the oona sound. Here each noun is *Marfoo'* according to its own structure.

4. When the Mubtada is of mixed gender

Rule: If nouns of both genders come together within the *Mubtada* of a sentence, the *Khabar* is always brought in the masculine. This is the rule of *Taghleeb*.

The same principle operates in Urdu and in English usage. Joining "Zayd is standing" and "Maryam is standing" gives "Zayd and Maryam are standing" — the masculine form carries both.

زَيْنَبُ وَمَرْيَمُ وَزَيْدٌ صَالِحُونَ

(Zaynab, Maryam and Zayd are righteous)

Zaynab and Maryam are feminine and Zayd is masculine. Since the *Mubtada* is of mixed gender and plural in number, the *Khabar* has been brought not as the feminine صَالِحَاتٌ but as the masculine *Jam' Salim* صَالِحُونَ.

5. More than one Khabar for a single Mubtada

More than one *Khabar* may be brought for a single *Mubtada*, and placing the *Harful 'Atf* waw between them or leaving it out are both correct.

- Without the *Harful 'Atf*: زَيْدٌ صَالِحٌ جَمِيلٌ مُجْتَهِدٌ
- With the *Harful 'Atf*: زَيْدٌ صَالِحٌ وَجَمِيلٌ وَمُجْتَهِدٌ

Both translate alike: Zayd is righteous, handsome and hardworking.

6. The Mu'arraḥ bil Lam as Mubtada

When *أل* is placed at the beginning of a *Nakirah* noun in Arabic, that noun becomes particular and determined, that is, it becomes *Ma'rifah*. Such a noun is called *Mu'arraḥ bil Lam*, and it can serve as the *Mubtada*.

'Adad	Mudhakkar	Mu'annath	Translation
Wahid	الْوَلَدُ صَالِحٌ	الْبِنْتُ صَالِحَةٌ	the boy / the girl is righteous
Tathniyah	الْوَلَدَانِ صَالِحَانِ	الْبِنَتَانِ صَالِحَتَانِ	the two boys / two girls are righteous
Jam'	الْوِلْدَانُ صَالِحُونَ	الْبَنَاتُ صَالِحَاتُ	the boys / the girls are righteous

In the first example *الْوَلَدُ صَالِحٌ* both nouns are singular, masculine and *Marfoo'*; the *Mubtada* is *Ma'rifah* and the *Khabar Nakirah*. And in *الْبِنْتُ صَالِحَةٌ* the *Khabar* has been brought in the feminine to match a feminine *Mubtada*.

The difference between Bint and Banat: In the singular *بِنْتٌ* the baa' carries a kasrah, whereas in its plural *بَنَاتٌ* the baa' is read with a fathah, because that is how native speakers pronounce it.

7. The word Imra'ah and its forms

In Arabic *الرَّجُل* is used for a man, and opposite it the word used for a woman is *امْرَأَةٌ*, meaning "a woman".

وَإِنْ امْرَأَةٌ خَافَتْ مِنْ بَعْلِهَا نُشُورًا أَوْ إِعْرَاضًا فَلَا جُنَاحَ عَلَيْهِمَا أَنْ يُصْلِحَا بَيْنَهُمَا صُلْحًا وَالصُّلْحُ خَيْرٌ

(Surah an-Nisa: 128)

Translation: And if a woman fears ill-treatment or indifference from her husband, there is no blame upon the two of them if they settle matters between themselves; and settlement is better.

When al- enters the word

When **الـ** enters **امْرَأَة**, it is read as **الْمَرْأَة**. This word does not occur in the Qur'an in that form, but it does occur in hadith.

الدُّنْيَا مَتَاعٌ وَخَيْرُ مَتَاعِ الدُّنْيَا الْمَرْأَةُ الصَّالِحَةُ

(narrated from 'Abdullah ibn 'Amr, may Allah be pleased with them both)

Translation: The world is a provision, and the best provision of the world is a righteous woman.

The Tathniyah and the Jam'

- For the *Tathniyah* the word used is **الْمَرَأَتَانِ**.
- **الْمَرْأَة** or **امْرَأَة** has no plural of its own from the same word; its *Jam' Mukassar* is **النِّسَاء** or **نِسْوَة**.

The technical name: A plural whose letters are entirely different from those of its singular is called, in grammatical terminology, *Jam' min ghayr lafzi wahidihi*. The plural of **امْرَأَة** as **نِسَاء** belongs to this class.

The difference between Niswah and Nisa'

Although both words mean "women", their usage differs.

Word	Which kind of plural	Usage
نِسْوَة	Jam' Qillah	Used for a small number of women, generally from three to ten
نِسَاء	Jam' Kathrah	Used for a larger number or for women in general. This is the word used abundantly in the Qur'an, as in Surah an-Nisa

وَقَالَ نِسْوَةٌ فِي الْمَدِينَةِ امْرَأَتُ الْعَزِيزِ تُرَاوِدُ فَتَاهَا عَنْ نَفْسِهِ قَدْ شَغَفَهَا حُبًّا

(Surah Yusuf: 30)

Translation: And some women in the city said: the wife of the 'Aziz is seeking to seduce her slave boy; he has certainly filled her heart with love.

Here a few women, that is a small number, are meant, which is why the word **نِسْوَة** has come.

8. The word Imru' and its distinctive I'raab

The common Arabic word for a man is رَجُل, but another very fine word, اِمْرُؤ, is also used for it.

The distinctive feature: What is particular about this word is that its *I'raab* changes on its last two letters together — the raa' and the hamzah. In ordinary nouns the *I'raab* changes only on the final letter, but here both letters change side by side.

State of I'raab	Without al-	With al-
Marfoo'	اِمْرُؤٌ	اَلْمَرءُ
Mansoob	اِمْرَأً	اَلْمَرَأَ
Majroor	اِمْرِي	اَلْمَرءِ

The word occurs in the Qur'an in all three states of *I'raab*.

يَسْتَفْتُونَكَ ۚ قُلِ اللّٰهُ يُفْتِيكُمْ فِي الْكَلَلَةِ ۚ اِنْ اِمْرُؤٌ هَلَكَ لَيْسَ لَهُ وَلَدٌ وَلَهُ أُخْتٌ فَلَهَا نِصْفُ مَا تَرَكَ

(Surah an-Nisa: 176 — state of raf')

Translation: They ask you for a ruling. Say: Allah gives you a ruling concerning one who leaves neither ascendants nor descendants. If a man dies leaving no child but having a sister, she shall have half of what he left.

يَاخْتِ هَارُونَ مَا كَانَ أَبُوكِ امْرَأَ سَوْءٍ وَمَا كَانَتْ أُمُّكَ بَعْيًّا

(Surah Maryam: 28 — state of nasb)

Translation: O sister of Harun, your father was not an evil man, nor was your mother unchaste.

اِنَّ الَّذِيْنَ جَاءُوْا بِالْاِفْكِ عُصْبَةٌ مِّنْكُمْ ۚ لَا تَحْسَبُوْهُ شَرًّا لَّكُمْ ۚ بَلْ هُوَ خَيْرٌ لَّكُمْ ۚ لِكُلِّ امْرِئٍ مِّنْهُمْ مَّا اكْتَسَبَ مِنَ الْاِثْمِ

(Surah an-Nur: 11 — state of jarr)

Translation: Indeed those who came with the slander are a group among you. Do not think it evil for you; rather it is good for you. For every man among them is what he earned of the sin.

يَوْمَ يَقْرَأُ الْمَرْءُ مِنْ اَخِيهِ

(Surah 'Abasa: 34 — the state of raf' with al-)

Translation: The day a man will flee from his brother.

9. Nouns beginning with the Hamzat ul Wasl

Some Arabic nouns begin with a hamzah that is a *Hamzat ul Wasl*.

Rule: The rule of the *Hamzat ul Wasl* is that when it is joined to what comes before it, it is written but not pronounced — that is, no vowel is sounded upon it.

9.1 Ism

In the du'a said before sleeping, **اللَّهُمَّ بِاسْمِكَ أَمُوتُ وَأَحْيَا**, when **اسم** joined the preceding **baa'**, the vowel of the hamzah fell away and it was read as **بِاسْمِكَ**.

9.2 Ibn

إِذْ قَالَتِ الْمَلَكَةُ يٰمَرْيَمُ إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُبَشِّرُكِ بِكَلِمَةٍ مِنْهُ ۚ اسْمُهُ الْمَسِيحُ عِيسَى ابْنُ مَرْيَمَ وَجِيهًا فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالْآخِرَةِ وَمِنَ الْمُقَرَّبِينَ

(Surah Al 'Imran: 45)

Translation: When the angels said: O Maryam, Allah gives you glad tidings of a word from Him, whose name is the Messiah, 'Isa son of Maryam, honoured in this world and the Hereafter and among those brought near.

The same word occurs in hadith:

لَا تَزُولُ قَدَمَا ابْنِ آدَمَ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ مِنْ عِنْدِ رَبِّهِ حَتَّى يُسْأَلَ عَنْ خَمْسٍ

Translation: The two feet of the son of Adam will not move from before his Lord on the Day of Resurrection until he is questioned about five things.

9.3 Ibnah

This word is also written in the Qur'an as **ابنت**.

وَمَرْيَمَ ابْنَتَ عِمْرَانَ الَّتِي أَحْصَنَتْ فَرْجَهَا فَنَفَخْنَا فِيهِ مِنْ رُوحِنَا وَصَدَّقْتَ بِكَلِمَاتِ رَبِّهَا وَكَانَتْ مِنَ الْقَانِتِينَ

(Surah at-Tahrim: 12)

Translation: And Maryam, the daughter of 'Imran, who guarded her chastity, so We breathed into it of Our spirit; and she believed in the words of her Lord and His books, and she was of the devoutly obedient.

9.4 Imra'ah

Its example is Surah an-Nisa verse 128, given above: **وَإِنْ امْرَأَةٌ خَافَتْ مِنْ بَعْلِهَا** — here too the vowel of the hamzah has fallen away after **وَإِنْ**.

9.5 Ithnan and Ithnayn

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا شَهِادَةُ بَيْنِكُمْ إِذَا خِصَرَ أَحَدَكُمُ الْمَوْتُ حِينَ الْوَصِيَّةِ اثْنِ ذَوَا عَدْلٍ مِّنْكُمْ أَوْ أُخْرَىٰ مِنْ غَيْرِكُمْ

(Surah al-Ma'idah: 106)

Translation: O you who believe, when death approaches one of you, the testimony among you at the time of the bequest shall be of two just men from among you, or two others from outside.

ثَمْنِيَّةَ أَزْوَاجٍ مِّنَ الضَّانِّ اثْنَيْنِ وَمِنَ الْمَعْزِ اثْنَيْنِ

(Surah al-An'am: 143)

Translation: Eight pairs: of sheep two and of goats two.

9.6 Ithnatan and Ithnatayn

وَإِذِ اسْتَسْقَىٰ مُوسَىٰ لِقَوْمِهِ فَقُلْنَا اضْرِبْ بِعَصَاكَ الْحَجَرَ ۖ فَانْفَجَرَتْ مِنْهُ اثْنَتَا عَشْرَةَ عَيْنًا

(Surah al-Baqarah: 60)

Translation: And when Musa prayed for water for his people, We said: strike the rock with your staff. Then twelve springs gushed forth from it.

قَالُوا رَبَّنَا آمَنَّا اِثْنَيْنِ وَاٰحْيَيْتَنَا اِثْنَيْنِ فَاَعْرَفْنَا بِذُنُوبِنَا فَهَلْ اِلٰى خُرُوجٍ مِّنْ سَبِيلٍ

(Surah Ghafir: 11)

Translation: They will say: our Lord, You gave us death twice and gave us life twice, so we confess our sins. Is there then any way out?

The complete list: In the view of the grammarians there are ten nouns beginning with a *Hamzat ul Wasl*. Besides the six above, the remaining four are: اَمْرٌ (discussed earlier), اَيْمَنَ, اِسْتِ (used in oaths) and اِئْتَمَ. Besides nouns, the *Hamzat ul Wasl* also occurs in verbs and in اَلْ.

Summary

1. A collection of two or more words is called a Murakkab. One from which the full sense is understood is a Murakkab Tamm; one from which it is not is a Murakkab Naqis.
2. A Jumla Ismiyyah begins with an Ism and a Jumla Fi'liyyah with a Fi'l.
3. A Jumla Ismiyyah has two parts: the Muftada and the Khabar. The Khabar may be an Ism and it may also be a Fi'l.
4. The first condition concerns wus'at: the Muftada is Ma'rifah and the Khabar Nakirah. This holds in 99 percent of cases.
5. The second condition concerns I'raab: both the Muftada and the Khabar are always Marfoo'. This is binding 100 percent.
6. The third condition is agreement in 'adad and jins, and this too holds in 99 percent of cases.
7. جِبْرِيلُ became the Muftada without Tanween because it is Ghayr Munsarif. مَلَكٌ with a fathah is an angel and مَلِكٌ with a kasrah is a king.
8. Apart from six, all the names of the Prophets are Ghayr Munsarif, which is why يُوسُفُ and يُونسُ carry only a single dammah.
9. The names of cities and countries are likewise Ghayr Munsarif. The plural of بَلَدٌ is بِلَادٌ, used for both a city and a country.
10. الْأَوَّلَادُ is a Jam' Mukassar made Marfoo' by a dammah, while صَالِحُونَ is a Jam' Salim Mudhakkar made Marfoo' by the oona sound.
11. If both genders come together in the Muftada, the Khabar is always brought in the masculine, which is the rule of Taghleeb.
12. A single Muftada may have more than one Khabar, with or without the Harf ul 'Atf.
13. Placing al- on a Nakirah noun makes it Mu'arraf bil Lam and fit to serve as the Muftada.
14. In the singular بِنْتُ the baa' carries a kasrah, but in its plural بَنَاتٌ the baa' is read with a fathah.
15. For a woman the word is امْرَأَةٌ, read with al- as الْمَرْأَةُ. Its Tathniyah is الْمَرْأَتَانِ.
16. امْرَأَةٌ has no plural from its own word; its plural is نِسَاءٌ or نِسْوَةٌ, which is called Jam' min ghayr lafzi wahidihi.
17. نِسْوَةٌ is a Jam' Qillah used for three to ten, and نِسَاءٌ is a Jam' Kathrah used for a larger number.
18. Another word for a man is امْرُؤٌ, whose I'raab changes on its last two letters together.
19. الْمَرْءُ, الْمَرْءُ, and امْرُؤٌ all occur in the Qur'an, and with al- they become الْمَرْءُ, الْمَرْءُ, and امْرُؤٌ.
20. The Hamzat ul Wasl is written when joined to a preceding word but is not pronounced.
21. The six well-known nouns beginning with a Hamzat ul Wasl are: اِسْمٌ, اِبْنٌ, اِبْنَةٌ, اِمْرَأَةٌ, اِثْنَانِ, and اِثْنَتَانِ.

Exercise

1. Explain the difference between a Murakkab Tamm and a Murakkab Naqis with examples.

2. Define both parts of a Jumla Ismiyyah.
3. Set out all three conditions for the Muftada and the Khabar in a table, stating how strictly each holds.
4. Give a full analysis of مُحَمَّدٌ نَبِيٌّ.
5. What is the difference between مَلِكٌ and مَلِكٌ?
6. In يُوسُفُ وَيُونُسُ نَبِيَّانِ, why do the two names carry no Tanween, and why is the Khabar in the Tathniyah?
7. State why there is no Tanween in بَابِلٌ وَمَكَّةُ بِلَادٌ, and give the plural of بَلَدٌ.
8. In الْأَوْلَادُ صَالِحُونَ, explain separately how each of the two nouns is Marfoo'.
9. What is the ruling on the Khabar when the Muftada is of mixed gender? Give one example.
10. Form sentences with the Mu'arraf bil Lam in the singular, dual and plural, masculine and feminine.
11. What is the difference in vovelling between بَنَاتٌ and بَنَاتٌ, and why?
12. Write the Tathniyah and the plural forms of امْرَأَةٌ.
13. Explain the difference between نِسَاءٌ and نِسْوَةٌ, and give a Qur'anic example of each.
14. Write all three states of I'raab of امْرُؤٌ, both without al- and with al-.
15. Write the rule of the Hamzat ul Wasl and name the six nouns that carry it.
16. Why is بِاسْمِكَ read in the du'a before sleeping rather than بِاسْمِكَ?

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ